Chapter 10

Differential Calculus-
Differentiability and Methods of Differentiation

V4S9PE

"Take what you need,
do what you should, you will get what you want"

- Leibnitz

10.1 Introduction

In this chapter we discuss the concept of derivative and related concepts and develop tools necessary for solving real life problems. In this connection, let us look at the following problem of finding average velocity.

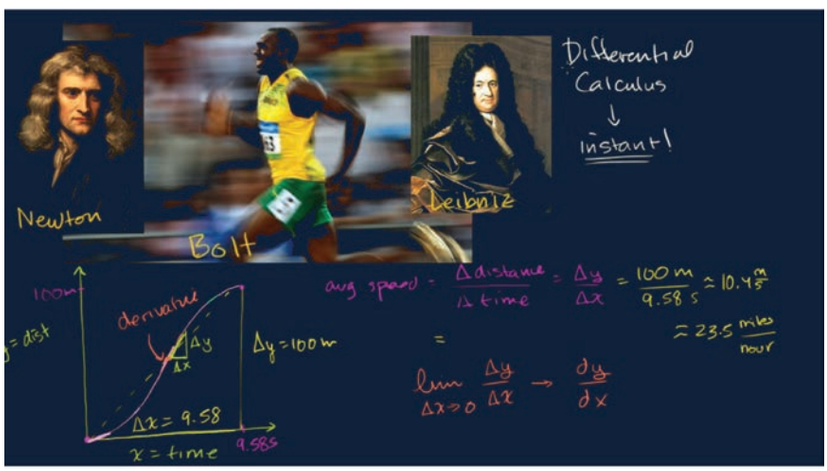
Almost everyone has an intuitive notion of speed or velocity as a rate at which a distance is covered in a certain length of time. When, say, a bus travels 60 km in one hour, the average velocity of the bus must have been 60 km/h. Of course, it is difficult to maintain this rate of 60 km/h for the entire trip because the bus slows down for towns and speeds up when it passes cars. In other words, the velocity changes with time. If a bus company's schedule demands that the bus travel 60 km from one town to another in one hour, the driver knows instinctively that he must compensate for velocities or speeds greater than this at other points in the journey. Knowing that the average velocity is 60 km/h does not, however, answer the question: What is the velocity of the bus at a particular instant?

In general, this average velocity or average speed of a moving object is the time rate of change of position defined by

$$v_{ave} = \frac{\text{distance travelled}}{\text{time of travel}}$$

Consider a runner who finishes a 10 km race in an elapsed time of 1 h 15 min (1.25 h). The runner's average velocity or average speed for this race is

$$v_{ave} = \frac{10}{1.25} = 8.$$



Usain Bolt's average speed

$$\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x} = \frac{100m}{9.58s} = 10.4$$

How fast is Usain Bolt right now? → Calculus

But suppose we now wish to determine the runner's exact velocity v at the instant the runner is one-half into the race. If the distance run in the time interval from 0 h to 0.5 h is measured to be 5 km, then $v_{ave} = \frac{5}{0.5} = 10$.

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